secure. It is now the plan of the Government to recruit an additional force of 500,000 for service during war-time, but it is extremely doubtful if the Government will be able to raise even a part of this force.

Out of this total figure of 250,000 the British troops including auxiliaries, number 70,000. The Indian troops number about 1,80,000 but they are officered by the British. There is only a small percentage of Indian Officers for the Indian soldiers.

The Indian army is eqipped with modern equipment like aeroplanes, tanks, armoured cars, mechanised transport, heavy artillery etc. though their number is small. They have so far proved to be enough for holding the country in subjugation, but they are most inadequate for fighting a modern army possessing modern equipment.

Rifles, small ammunition and explosives are now being manufactured in India, but other modern equipment like aeroplanes, tanks, armoured cars, motor cars, lorries, heavy artillery etc. are all imported. During the last few months the British authorities have been constructing large underground shelters on the hillside near the North Western Frontier of India for storing bombs, ammunition etc.

The British section of the Army in India having a maximum strength of 70,000 is the only loyal force in India on whom the British Government can fully depend. The Indian section of the army has many anti-British elements and perhaps the only group that will be loyal to the British is composed of the Punjabi Muslims. The Punjabi Sikhs—the best fighters in the Indian Army—are the most anti-British at the present time. Since the war began, many regiments of Punjabi Sikhs have mutinied and they have been court-martialled. I know this from personal experience, because those who were not shot, were sentenced to long terms of imprisonment and then they were transported to the Andaman Islands; they passed through the same jail in which I was incarcerated from July to December, 1940, viz. the Presidency Jail in Calcutta.

As already stated above, British prestige in India is shattered as a result of the many defeats which the British have suffered in the present war. As a matter of fact, after the fall of France in June, 1940, the Indian Army was in a mood in which there was utter lack of confidence in British military strength. That was the